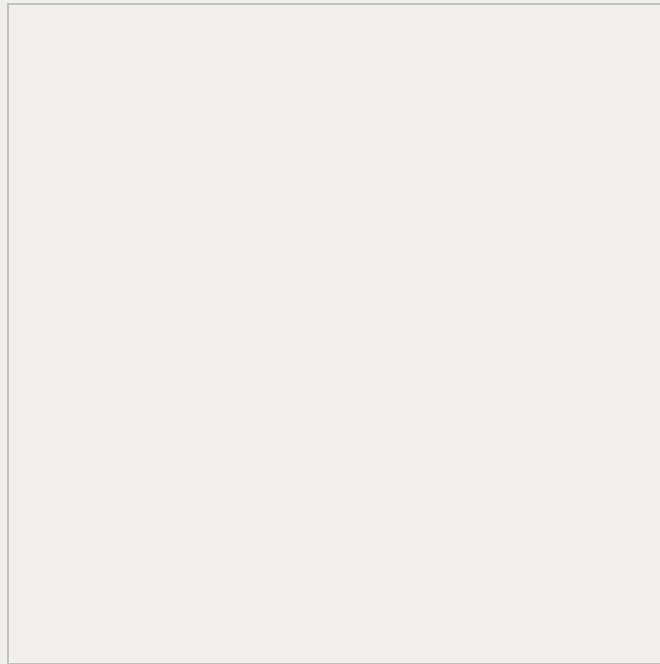


ON TECHNIQUE

From neumes to staff notation

The numerous chants of the Catholic Church were originally learned by rote by the monks and then passed on orally. However, from around the 9th century, graphic symbols, known as neumes, began to appear above the texts to suggest the shape of the melody. In time, these were placed on a horizontal line representing a pitch, such as C or F. Guido is credited with the idea of using four lines (which were later expanded to the familiar five-line staff) to identify the precise pitch of each note.



12TH-CENTURY MUSIC NOTATION SHOWING
DIASTEMATIC OR HEIGHTENED NEUMES AND
A SINGLE-LINE STAFF